## A chatbot (large language model)

e.g. ChatGPT, Gemini, Claude

*"This student has logged in 12 times and is 35. Will this student pass?"*

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**Trained on text**
to predict the next word;
general-purpose by design

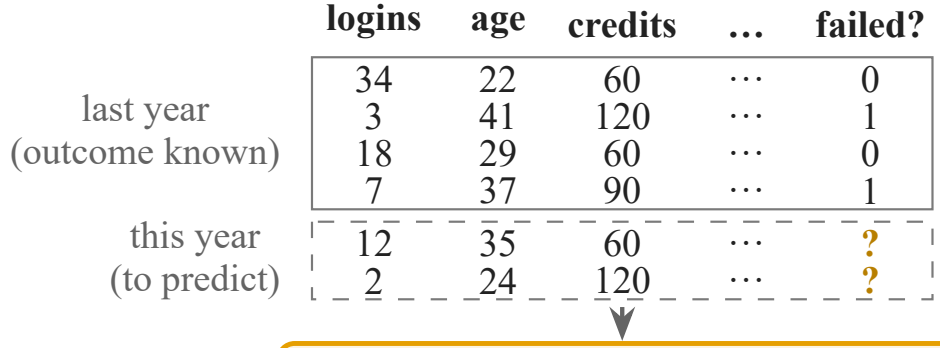
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*"Students with low activity early in a course often struggle, so this student may be at some risk…"*

reads sentences · returns a paragraph

## A tabular foundation model

e.g. TabPFN, TabICL




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**Trained on millions of synthetic tables**
to fill in a missing column
from the rows above it

↓

risk of failing: **0.72** and **0.18**

reads numbers · returns a probability

**What they share:** both are *foundation models* — trained once, at large scale, then used without retraining. **What differs:** a chatbot answers questions; a tabular foundation model fills in a column of a spreadsheet.